

and finally anybody and everybody who ever liked *Star Wars* would, and must, definitely try this game. Of course this game has also recieved a lot of criticism—there are those who do not want their single-player-only favourite to be converted into an MMO, others say that this game will not do well with the prevailing market condition as the MMO market is currently dominated by *World of Warcraft*. Warranted, or unwarranted criticisms aside, this game will definitely be a delight as it can be considered a step up from the traditional setup of Mages, Wizards, Nights, Elves and Orcs, which is so common that it has begun to get boring to some extent. www.swtor.com is where you need to head if you're interested to learn more about this game.



BattleForge (PC)

Okay, this game is just amazing. It's so good it actually can't be classified, but let's try to do it anyway. This game can only be played online, so let's start off by saying that it's an online game. But since many people can play it simultaneously, it's an MMO. It has PvP and PvE elements to it which would then make it somewhat of an MMORPG. Here's the catch though: you don't sit and control a single character, but an army—which makes it an RTS, so it's an online RTS, or an MMORTS, if you have been keeping tabs. You build and control your own army and complete missions in co-op, or fight against one another to improve your own skills. Another innovation presented through the game is that the way you build your army is through a card-based system. You can choose to build your army based on multiple elemental types. Building units and killing creeps and enemies will definitely need co-operation with your fellow players and also macro-management of your own army making this a very interesting game to play. Keep up with the news about this game at www.battleforge.com.



Fallen Earth (PC)

The bar for MMORPGs have been raised in 2008 with the release of games like *Age of Conan*, which takes gameplay and graphics to a new level, and through the release of expansions for games such as *Eve Online*



and *World of Warcraft*. MMORPGs are a unique genre of games and call for dedicated gamers (some might say obsessive to a fault) to play them. Hence, the new games that are coming out need to avoid the treaded path and break out with something new. Well, we have found a really great game that promises to offer just that. The game is called *Fallen Earth* and the storyline actually seems half-plausible: There is a virus that has spread and destroyed most of the Earth's population and has mutated through different stages. The virus was created somewhere in South Asia and when it came in touch with Pakistan, they immediately thought the virus had origins in India; Pakistan then attacks and through the attack starts the virus to spread further. The virus, called the Shiva virus, then mutates to different stages. Players can choose one of many professions offered in this game, with classes such as engineers, enforcers, travellers, and so on, each of which with their respective factions. This game offers a completely new story, a fresh setting, new professions, and hopefully, new game play. It is definitely one the MMORPG enthusiasts should wait for. Learn more about *Fallen Earth* on its official web site: www.fallenearth.com.

Killzone 2 (PS3)

Killzone is a sci-fi FPS game which follows the storyline of *Killzone: Liberation* (for the PlayStation Portable) and is the third game in this franchise following the original's release on the PlayStation 2 console. The story of *Killzone 2* is quite straight forward: two years after the Vekta attack by the Helghast, the Interplanetary Strategic Alliance (ISA) is taking the fight back to the enemy's home world of Helghan. You play as Sev, a hardcore battle-monger who is sent to capture the Helghast Leader, Emperor Visari, and bring their war machine to a halt. *Killzone 2* aims to provide players with a realistic gameplay, dubbed "Hollywood Realism" by the developers. There is also a new cover system called "lean and peek" which will be a great addition to this game. Visit www.killzone.com for more information about the game.



Warhammer 40,000: Dawn of War II (PC)

The *Dawn of War II* sequel in the Warhammer 40,000 universe is also an RTS which differs from its predecessors. The campaign mode allows for a pick-up and play experience by allowing you to select your army, the mission and diving straight into the action. It does away with the 'distraction' of base-building and

the boredom of micro-managing resources. This game will thus offer a new style of RTS by moving away from the traditional building aspect as it focuses more on the front-line combat. The campaign can be accomplished in single player as well as in co-op mode. Head over to www.dawnofwar2.com for more details about the game.



Tekken 6 (Xbox360, PS3)

Tekken 6 will be the first game based on the System 257 arcade board to be launched on the PlayStation 3. It is the latest in the *Tekken* series and will retain all the elements from *Tekken 5* and *Tekken 5: The Dark Ressurrection*. This installment will also have an online mode which will be great fun. You can now challenge your arch-nemesis to a game without him actually being in your house using your console. New 'item' moves have also been implemented where characters use special items to attack the opponent. Also Namco has added a new 'Rage' system where on using Rage, your attack increases by huge amounts to the cost of your health reducing. There are a total of 42 characters which essentially means all the characters from *Tekken 5: The Dark Ressurrection* are present with an addition of new characters. Out of the new characters, six have been confirmed: Zafina, Leo, Miguel Caballero Rojo, Bob, Azazel (the final Boss of the game) and NANCY-MI847J. For more information check out <http://tekken.namco.com>.



Ghostbusters (PS3, PS2, Xbox360, Nintendo Wii & DS, PC)

When there's something strange in the neighbourhood, who ya gonna call....Ghostbusters! You heard the call right, *Ghostbusters* the game is going to be released sometime in 2009, and will be a continuation of the movie franchise. The game picks up two years after the events in *Ghostbusters II*. You play a new recruit who has been hired to test some equipment created by Egon Spengler and Ray Stantz because the paranormal activity has increased in the city. This activity is actually being caused due to the release of a Gozer exhibit. The storyline doesn't seem as interesting as it is very similar to that of the actual movie, but the fun part will definitely be in playing through the story. Also look forward



to is how the gameplay will actually work in this game. Gameplay involves a third-person perspective on the HD consoles, similar to *Gears of War*. The Nintendo Wii version will offer a cell-shaded graphical appeal and will be played in the third-person with the Wii Remote acting as the Ghostbusters' gun.

The Chronicles of Riddick: Assault on Dark Athena (Xbox360, PS3, PC)

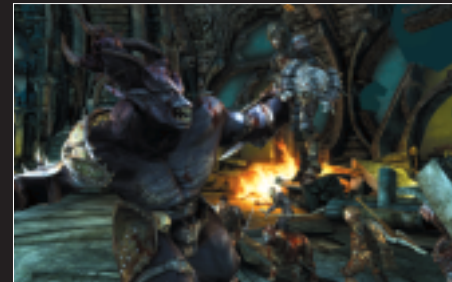
This science fiction FPS was originally anticipated to be a remake of *The Chronicles of Riddick: Escape from Butcher Bay*, but it has grown to such an extent that it now being considered a sequel. There isn't much information on this game, but from what we have seen it looks spectacular. Vin Diesel did an amazing job in the movie franchise and he has been portrayed brilliantly in the game as well, even his voice has been used. This game is expected to have great graphics and an advanced AI and also a multi-player mode. We hope that this sequel does deliver all that it has promised. More can be found out at www.riddickgame.com.



Dragon Age: Origins (PC, PS3, Xbox360)

Dragon Age is an RPG being developed by BioWare; forged using a new game engine called Eclipse. The reason why this game is sub-titled 'Origins' is because the game incorporates an origins story for each race and some classes. An origin story will determine the background of the main character prior to the main storyline. Which means, a Dwarf

Noble will begin the game as part of the royal family in one of the Dwarven cities, and a Dwarf Commoner will begin on the streets of the city. This will give you many hours of gameplay and these characters will reappear throughout the game. The game is described as being a 'dark heroic fantasy' story which will be portrayed on an epic scale with mature themes. Players start the game through one of the six Origin stories and will be playing that character's point of view. On choosing the Origin, the game determines the appropriate behaviour of the NPCs and their consequent reactions with the player. With BioWare at helm, this game ought to have an interesting story. More information can be found at <http://dragonage.bioware.com>. ■



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